Late-blight lesion scoring on the Kestrel farms: a labelling note

1. Scope. This note describes the labelling protocol used for the 2021 potato late-blight survey on the three Kestrel farms, and the two quality problems the annotation team reported afterwards. It is a claim sheet, not a full paper: it exists so that the claims below can be checked against the field data rather than taken on trust.

2. Protocol. Images were captured by fixed trap cameras at four plots. Each image was scored for late-blight lesion coverage on a percentage scale by a single annotator, with 10% of images double-scored as a check. Capture hour is recorded in local time from the camera clock. Field readings of leaf temperature and relative humidity were taken at the same plots within the same hour.

3. Claim one: contamination rate. The team estimates that 12.4% of the labelled images in this survey carry a wrong lesion score, concentrated in images where the lesion colour and the soil-splash pattern were hard to distinguish.

4. Claim two: contamination is a night-time problem. The team reports that 71% of the contaminated images were captured between 19:00 and 05:00 under LED illumination, and that daytime images from the same plots carry a much lower contamination rate. This is the claim the field data can test.

5. Claim three: lesion scores above 60% are implausible. The note states that no untreated Kestrel plot reached 60% lesion coverage in 2021, so any score above that threshold in the survey data should be treated as a scoring error rather than a finding.

6. Limitations stated by the authors. The estimate is metadata-derived, the double-scored share is only 10%, and the survey covers one crop and one season.